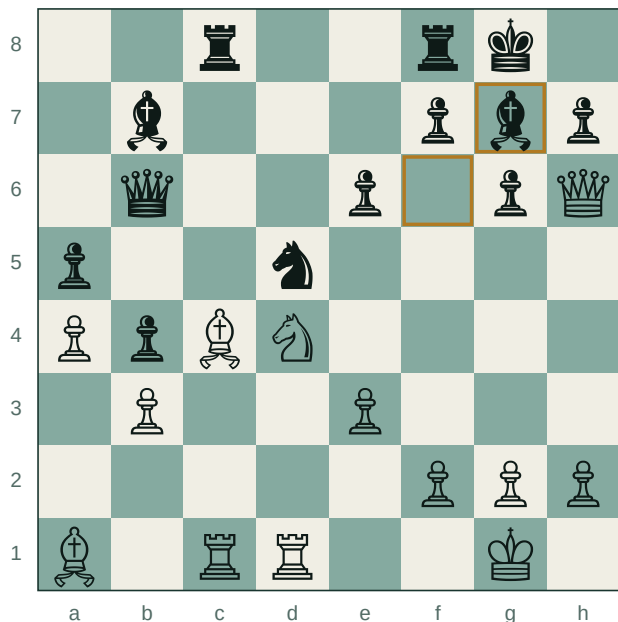


Double checks: White, move 24

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 23...Bg7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24. Qxg7+ Kxg7 25. Nf5+ Kg8 26. Nh6#

24.Qxg7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From g7 it attacks king on g8 and rook on f8. Recorded reply: **24...Kxg7**.

25.Nf5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the rook on d1 attacks the knight on d5. Recorded reply: **25...Kg8**.

26.Nh6# Mate: knight on h6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Knight on h6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.